

SS3 BEAUTY AND COSMETOLOGY LESSON NOTES

FIRST TERM

WEEK 1: REVISION OF SS1 & SS2 WORK

TOPIC: GENERAL REVIEW OF KEY CONCEPTS

Introduction

This week is dedicated to refreshing our memories on the foundational knowledge from SS1 and SS2. A strong grasp of these core concepts—from hygiene and skin science to basic artistry and hair chemistry—is essential for mastering the advanced entrepreneurial and professional topics we will cover in SS3.

A. Review of SS1: Foundations of cosmetology

1. Hygiene and sanitation:

- **Definitions:** Differentiating between Sanitation (reducing pathogens), Disinfection (killing most pathogens), and Sterilization (killing all microbial life, including spores).
- **Tools:** Antiseptics (for skin) vs. Disinfectants (for tools/surfaces).
- **Salon safety:** Personal hygiene (hand washing), tool hygiene (barbicide, UV sterilizer), and client safety (patch tests, contraindications).

2. Anatomy and physiology (skin and nails):

- **Skin:** The three layers (Epidermis, Dermis, Subcutaneous). Functions of the skin (Protection, Sensation, Heat regulation, Excretion, Absorption, Vitamin D production).
- **Skin types:** Identifying and understanding Normal, Dry (alipoid), Oily (sebaceous), and Combination skin.
- **Nails:** The structure of the nail (Matrix, Nail Plate, Nail Bed, Cuticle, Free Edge).

3. Basic manicure and pedicure:

- **Tools:** Cuticle pusher, nipper, file, buffer, orangewood stick, foot scrub, etc.

- **Procedure:** The 5-step process (Soak, File, Cuticle care, Massage, Polish).
- **Contraindications:** Conditions that prevent treatment (e.g., fungus, warts, open wounds).

B. Review of SS2: Advanced skills

1. Basic hair care and chemistry:

- **Hair structure:** The cuticle, cortex, and medulla.
- **Hair porosity:** The hair's ability to absorb moisture (low, normal, high).
- **The pH scale:** Understanding the acidic (0-6.9) and alkaline (7.1-14) nature of products. The hair and skin are naturally acidic (pH 4.5-5.5).
- **Chemical services:**
 - **Relaxers (Alkaline):** Sodium hydroxide (lye) or calcium hydroxide (no-lye). They work by breaking the disulfide bonds in the cortex.
 - **Perms (Acid/Alkaline):** Ammonium thioglycolate (thio) waves. They break and re-form disulfide bonds.

2. Basic facial treatments:

- **Tools:** Steamer, exfoliating brush, extraction tool, magnifying lamp.
- **Products:** Cleanser, toner, exfoliant (physical vs. chemical), mask (clay, hydrating), moisturizer.
- **Procedure:** Cleanse, Analyze, Exfoliate, Steam, Extract (if needed), Massage, Mask, Tone, Moisturize, Protect (SPF).

3. Basic makeup artistry:

- **Tools:** Brushes (foundation, powder, blush, eyeshadow), sponges, eyelash curler.
- **Products:** Primer, foundation (matching undertones), concealer, powder, brow pencil, eyeshadow, eyeliner, mascara, blush, lipstick.
- **Application steps:** The standard order of application for a clean, everyday look.

Evaluation questions

1. What is the difference between "Sanitation" and "Sterilization"?
2. List the three main layers of the skin.

3. What is a "contraindication" in a pedicure?
4. Define "hair porosity."
5. What chemical product is used in a "lye" relaxer?

Assignment questions

1. In a table, differentiate between the procedures for a relaxer and a perm.
2. Describe the 10-step process for a professional basic facial.
3. Explain the "burn test" for identifying synthetic vs. natural hair extensions.
4. Create a chart of the four main skin types. For each type, list two common characteristics and one recommended product.
5. What is a "patch test," and why is it mandatory before applying any chemical (relaxer or hair dye)?



WEEK 2: PROFESSIONAL MAKEUP ARTISTRY I

TOPIC: PORTFOLIO BUILDING; SIGNATURE STYLES

Introduction

Moving from a student to a professional makeup artist (MUA) requires more than just skill; it requires proof of that skill. A portfolio is your visual résumé. This week, we explore how to build a powerful portfolio and how to develop a "signature style" that sets you apart from the competition.

A. What is a makeup portfolio?

A makeup portfolio is a curated collection of your best work, designed to showcase your skills, range, and artistic style to potential clients, employers, or collaborators.

- **Physical portfolio:** A high-quality art book or folder with professional 8x10 prints. This is essential for in-person interviews.
- **Digital portfolio:** An online showcase of your work. This is the most common and important. It can be:
 - An Instagram/Facebook page.
 - A personal website (e.g., using Wix, Squarespace).
 - A profile on a professional site (e.g., Behance).

B. Building a high-quality portfolio

1. **Quality over quantity:** 10 "wow" photos are better than 50 "okay" photos.
2. **High-quality images:** This is non-negotiable. Bad lighting and blurry photos will make even the best makeup look bad.
 - **Collaborate:** Partner with aspiring photographers and models ("Trade For Print" or TFP) to get professional photos for free.
 - **DIY:** If shooting yourself, use a good smartphone or camera, clean background, and bright, natural light (or a ring light).

3. **Show your range:** Your portfolio should demonstrate that you can handle different types of clients and requests. Include:
 - A "no-makeup" natural look.
 - A classic bridal look.
 - A bold, glamour look (e.g., smokey eye, glitter).
 - An editorial or creative look (see Week 3).
 - Work on various skin tones, ages, and face shapes.
4. **Before and afters:** These are powerful selling tools. Ensure the "before" shot is well-lit and the "after" shot is taken from the same angle.

C. Finding and developing your signature style

Your signature style is your artistic "brand"—the unique look or feeling that makes your work instantly recognizable.

- **Finding it:** What do you love to do?
 - Do you excel at hyper-realistic, glowing skin?
 - Are you known for your sharp, dramatic winged liner?
 - Is your speciality bold, artistic use of colour?
 - Are you the master of the "soft glam" bridal look?
- **Developing it:**
 1. **Inspiration:** Create "mood boards" (collections of inspiring images) from magazines, art, and nature.
 2. **Practice:** Practice your preferred style constantly.
 3. **Refine:** Ask for feedback. What do people praise most about your work?
- **Famous examples:**
 - **Pat McGrath:** Known for avant-garde, "otherworldly" looks with extreme texture (crystals, feathers).
 - **Banke Meshida-Lawal (BMPRO):** Known for flawless, glamorous, and transformative bridal makeup.
 - **Bibyonce:** Known for bold, defined, "Instagram-glam" makeup.

Evaluation questions

1. What is the difference between a physical and a digital portfolio?
2. What does "TFP" stand for, and why is it useful?
3. Why is it important to show "range" in your portfolio?
4. Define what a "signature style" is for a makeup artist.
5. What is a "mood board"?

Assignment questions

1. Create a 5-page "mood board" (digital or cut-and-paste) for a makeup portfolio you would like to build.
2. Research three famous makeup artists (Nigerian or international). For each one, write one paragraph describing their "signature style."
3. Write a simple, professional "call for collaboration" message that you could send to a photographer on Instagram.
4. Take a "before and after" photo of a makeup look you create (on yourself or a model), focusing on using the same angle and good lighting.
5. List 10 types of looks you would include in your ideal portfolio to show maximum range.

WEEK 3: PROFESSIONAL MAKEUP ARTISTRY II

TOPIC: HIGH FASHION, PHOTOGRAPHY AND EDITORIAL MAKEUP

Introduction

Beyond bridal and event makeup lies the world of high fashion and editorial work. This type of makeup is not about "pretty"; it's about "art" and "storytelling." It requires a different set of skills, an understanding of lighting, and the ability to work with a creative team.

A. Differentiating makeup categories

- **Event/Bridal makeup:** Designed to be beautiful in person and on camera, enhance the client's features, and last all day.
- **Photography makeup:** Designed to look flawless and intentional *through a camera lens*. It may look heavy or strange in person.
- **High-fashion/Runway makeup:** Designed to support a designer's clothing collection. It is often bold, artistic, and not meant for daily life.
- **Editorial makeup:** Designed to tell a story or fit a theme for a magazine, website, or advertisement.

B. Makeup for photography (studio/flash)

The camera lens and flash change everything.

1. **No SPF:** Products with SPF (Sun Protection Factor) contain ingredients (like titanium dioxide) that cause "flashback"—a white, ghostly cast on the face in flash photography.
2. **Mattify:** The flash highlights all shine. The skin (especially the T-zone) must be well-matted with powder.
3. **Contour and definition:** The flash flattens the face. You must use contour, blush, and brows to add back the dimension that the flash will wash out. Contouring must be blended flawlessly.
4. **"HD" makeup:** High-Definition (HD) products are made with fine, light-diffusing particles that "blur" the skin, making it look perfect on camera.

C. High-fashion (runway) makeup

- **Purpose:** To complement the designer's clothing and creative vision.
- **Characteristics:** Often abstract, exaggerated, and uniform. All models may have the same "unconventional" look (e.g., bleached brows, a single stripe of paint, glossy eyelids).
- **Application:** Speed is key. You must be able to create the look flawlessly and quickly backstage.

D. Editorial makeup

- **Purpose:** To tell a story or illustrate a concept (e.g., "Afrofuturism," "Urban Decay," "Water Goddess").
- **Characteristics:** This is pure artistry. It can be anything.
- **Key techniques:**
 - **Skin:** Can be anything from hyper-dewy ("glass skin") to fully matted or painted.
 - **Blocking:** "Eyebrow blocking" is a key skill where the brows are glued down and covered with wax and concealer so the artist can draw a new shape or paint over them.
 - **Graphic liner:** Using eyeliner to create bold, geometric shapes.
 - **Unconventional materials:** Using materials like feathers, crystals, gold leaf, glitter, or even prosthetics.

Evaluation questions

1. What is the main purpose of editorial makeup?
2. Why should you avoid using foundation with SPF for flash photography?
3. What is "flashback"?
4. What is "eyebrow blocking"?
5. What is the main difference between bridal makeup and high-fashion makeup?

Assignment questions

1. Sketch a face chart for an "editorial" makeup look based on the theme "Fire" or "Royalty."
2. Find one example of a high-fashion (runway) show online. Describe the makeup look and explain how it complemented the clothing.
3. Find one example of a makeup editorial in a magazine (like Vogue, Allure, or Genevieve). Describe the look and the "story" you think it is telling.
4. Research "HD Makeup." List two popular HD foundation brands and explain what makes them "HD."
5. List 5 "unconventional materials" that could be used in an avant-garde makeup look.



WEEK 4: BRIDAL AND EVENT MANAGEMENT IN BEAUTY

TOPIC: COORDINATING BRIDAL LOOKS; EVENT STYLING

Introduction

Being a bridal makeup artist is one of the most popular and profitable careers in cosmetology. However, it is not just about makeup. It is about being a project manager, a stylist, a scheduler, and a calming presence on the most important day of your client's life.

A. The role of the bridal beauty consultant

Your job is to manage the *entire* beauty look and timeline for the bride and her party (bridal train).

- **Key responsibilities:**

- Consultation and trial.
- Skincare and preparation advice.
- Makeup for the bride and bridal train (e.g., bridesmaids, mother of the bride).
- Coordinating with the hairstylist (Gele artist, if applicable).
- Managing the schedule on the wedding day.
- Providing touch-ups.

B. The bridal consultation and trial

This is the most important meeting before the wedding.

1. **Consultation:** This is a "counselling" session.

- **Ask questions:** What is your dress like (colour, style)? What is your venue? What time of day is the wedding? What is your personal style? Show me photos of makeup you love.
- **Skin analysis:** Assess her skin type and advise a simple skincare routine (e.g., "exfoliate twice a week and hydrate").

2. **Trial session:** This is a full "dress rehearsal" of the makeup.

- This is where you *confirm* the look.
- It allows you to test for product allergies.
- It builds trust and ensures the wedding day is smooth and fast.

C. Coordinating the complete look

The makeup must work in harmony with everything else.

- **The dresses:** A bride will often have two or more looks (e.g., Traditional and White Wedding). The makeup must change to suit each look.
 - **Traditional:** Often bolder, matching the colours of the *Aso-Oke* or fabric. May involve glitter and strong *gele*.
 - **White Wedding:** Often softer, more romantic (e.g., soft glam, natural).
- **The bridal train:** The bridesmaids' makeup should *complement* the bride, not overshadow her. It's usually a softer, uniform look that matches their dresses.

D. Event management: The wedding day

1. **The contract:** A professional MUA *always* uses a contract. It should include:
 - Date, time, and location.
 - Number of people for makeup.
 - Total price and deposit paid.
 - Cancellation policy.
 - Travel fees.
2. **The timeline:** You must create a strict schedule and share it with the bride.
 - *Example:*
 - 6:00 AM: MUA arrives and sets up.
 - 6:30 AM: 1st Bridesmaid
 - 7:30 AM: 2nd Bridesmaid
 - 8:30 AM: Mother of the Bride
 - 9:30 AM: **Bride's Makeup** (The bride is often last, so she is freshest).
 - 11:00 AM: Final touch-ups.
3. **The touch-up kit:** A small kit for the bride (or her helper) with essentials:

- Lipstick/gloss.
- Blotting paper or powder.
- Mini setting spray.
- Eyelash glue.

Evaluation questions

1. What is the purpose of a bridal "trial session"?
2. List three key questions to ask a bride during her consultation.
3. Why is a contract important for a bridal MUA?
4. Why should the bride's makeup often be done last?
5. List three essential items for a bridal touch-up kit.

Assignment questions

1. Create a detailed "Bridal Consultation Form" with at least 15 questions you would ask a new bride.
2. Create a sample "Wedding Day Timeline" for a bride, 3 bridesmaids, and the mother of the bride. The ceremony starts at 12 PM.
3. Research and write a simple one-page "Bridal Makeup Contract" template.
4. Assemble a "Bridal Touch-Up Kit" (you can list the 10 items you would include).
5. Find two photos of a "Traditional Wedding" look and two of a "White Wedding" look. In a paragraph, compare and contrast the makeup styles.

WEEK 5: MIDTERM TEST

This week is for the midterm test, which will cover all content from Weeks 1-4.

- **Topics:** SS1/SS2 Review, Portfolio Building, Signature Styles, Editorial/Photography Makeup, and Bridal Management.
- **Format:** A combination of objective questions, short-answer questions, and a practical (e.g., "design a face chart for a specific theme").



WEEK 6: COSMETOLOGY ENTREPRENEURSHIP PROJECT I

TOPIC: PROPOSAL WRITING; MARKET SURVEY

Introduction

Many cosmetologists dream of launching their own product line (e.g., soap, body butter, lip gloss, hair oil). This is the start of a two-week project where you will move from "idea" to "product." The first step is to create a business proposal and conduct a market survey to see if your idea is viable.

A. The business idea and proposal

1. **The idea:** Identify a "gap" in the market.
 - *Example:* "There is no affordable, locally-made lip balm that contains SPF."
 - *Example:* "People with sensitive skin need a natural black soap that isn't too harsh."
2. **The business proposal:** A simple written document that outlines your idea. It helps you think clearly and can be shown to parents or investors for funding.
 - **Key sections:**
 - **Executive Summary:** A 1-paragraph summary of the whole plan.
 - **Mission Statement:** Your "why." (e.g., "To create 100% natural, affordable skincare for Nigerian students.")
 - **Product Description:** What are you making? (e.g., "A 100g jar of Peppermint-infused Shea Body Butter.")
 - **Target Market:** Who will buy it? (e.g., "Women aged 18-30 who prefer organic products.")

B. What is a market survey?

A market survey is the process of gathering information from your potential customers to see if they *actually want or need* your product. This step prevents you from wasting time and money making something nobody will buy.

C. How to conduct a market survey

1. **Define your questions:** You need to know:

- **The problem:** Do you suffer from... (e.s., dry skin, acne, chapped lips)?
- **Current habits:** What products do you use now? How much do you pay?
- **The solution:** Would you buy... (e.g., a natural body butter)?
- **The price:** What is the *maximum* you would pay for this product?
- **The place:** *Where* would you prefer to buy this (e.g., online, in a salon, from a friend)?

2. **Choose your method:**

- **Questionnaire:** Create a simple 10-question survey (e.g., using Google Forms, or just pen and paper).
- **Interviews:** Talk directly to 10-20 people in your target market.
- **Observation:** Go to a market or salon and observe what people are buying.

3. **Analyze results:** Look at the answers.

- *If 9/10 people say they "would not pay more than ₦1,000," you cannot price your product at ₦3,000.*
- *If 8/10 people say they "prefer fruity scents," you should make a mango scrub, not a lavender one.*

D. Project brief (Part 1)

- **Task:** This week, you must form a group, decide on one simple product to create, and write a 1-page proposal. You must also create and conduct a market survey of at least 20 people.

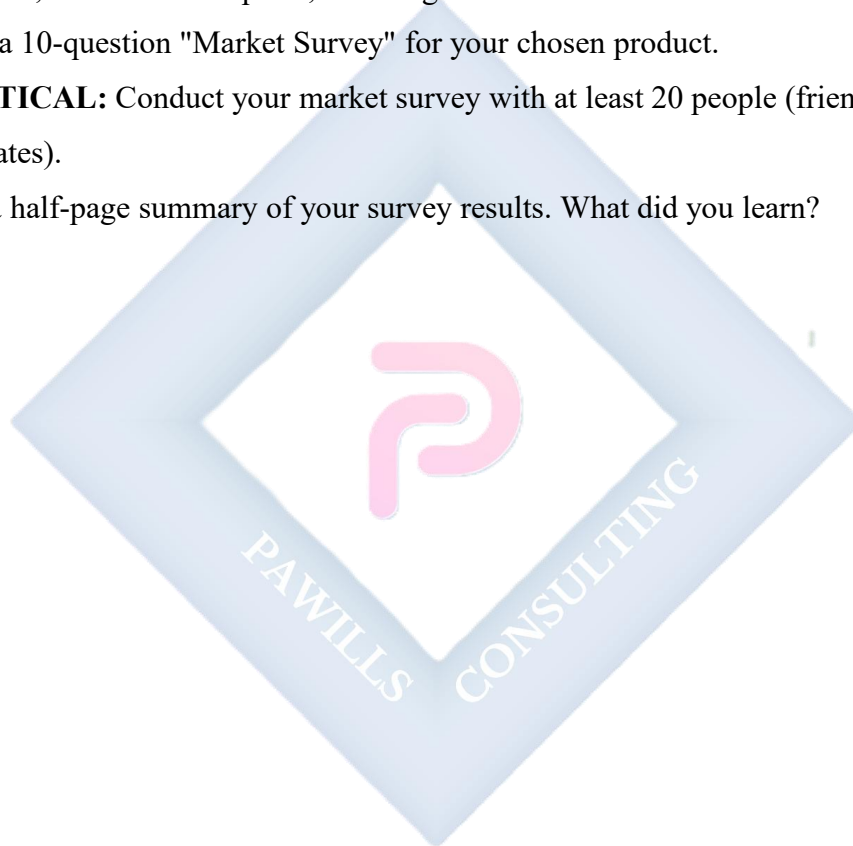
Evaluation questions

1. What is a "Mission Statement"?
2. What is a "Target Market"?
3. Why is a market survey important?
4. List three methods for conducting a market survey.

5. What is the main difference between a "problem" question and a "price" question in a survey?

Assignment questions

1. **PRACTICAL:** As a group or individual, decide on *one* simple cosmetic product you want to create (e.g., lip balm, sugar scrub, hair oil, body butter, melt-and-pour soap).
2. Write a simple 1-page "Business Proposal" for your product, including its Name, Mission Statement, Product Description, and Target Market.
3. Create a 10-question "Market Survey" for your chosen product.
4. **PRACTICAL:** Conduct your market survey with at least 20 people (friends, family, classmates).
5. Write a half-page summary of your survey results. What did you learn?



WEEK 7: MIDTERM BREAK

- Students should use the break to finalize their market survey results and source any ingredients needed for their practical product creation in Week 8.



WEEK 8: COSMETOLOGY ENTREPRENEURSHIP PROJECT II

TOPIC: PRACTICAL PRODUCT CREATION

Introduction

Following your proposal and market survey, this week is dedicated to the practical "hands-on" creation of your product. This is where formulation, safety, and packaging come to life.

A. Safety and formulation

1. **Sanitation:** This is the #1 rule. All tools, bowls, and containers must be sanitized with alcohol or boiling water. You must wear gloves.
2. **Measurements:** Use a digital scale for accuracy. "One spoon" is not a measurement. Cosmetic formulation is a science.
3. **Basic ingredients:**
 - **Oils (Carriers):** Coconut oil, Shea butter, Cocoa butter, Olive oil.
 - **Waxes:** Beeswax (to harden lip balms/balms).
 - **Exfoliants:** Sugar (for body), Brown Sugar (gentler, for face), Salt.
 - **Scents/Extras:** Essential oils (e.g., peppermint, lavender), Vitamin E (a natural antioxidant).
4. **Preservatives:**
 - Any product that contains water (e.g., a lotion, some scrubs) *must* have a preservative to prevent bacteria and mould.
 - For this project, we will focus on "anhydrous" (water-free) products like balms and oil-based scrubs, which do not need strong preservatives (Vitamin E is enough).

B. Simple product formulations (examples)

1. **Simple sugar scrub:**
 - 1 cup (200g) White Sugar
 - 1/2 cup (100g) Coconut Oil (melted)

- 1/2 teaspoon (2.5g) Vitamin E oil
- 10 drops of essential oil (e.g., Lemon)
- *Method:* Combine all ingredients and mix well.

2. **Basic lip balm:**

- 2 tbsp (30g) Beeswax pellets
- 2 tbsp (30g) Shea Butter
- 2 tbsp (30g) Coconut Oil
- *Method:* Melt all ingredients together in a "double boiler" (a bowl over a pot of hot water). Do not overheat. Pour into lip balm tubes or tins and let cool.

3. **"Melt and Pour" soap:**

- 500g "Melt and Pour" soap base (glycerin or goat's milk)
- 1 teaspoon (5g) cosmetic-safe fragrance oil
- A few drops of cosmetic-safe liquid colorant
- *Method:* Cut base into cubes, melt gently in a double boiler. Stir in colour and fragrance. Pour into a silicone mold and let it harden.

C. Costing, packaging and labeling

1. **Costing (Cost Per Unit):** You *must* calculate how much it costs to make ONE product.
 - *Example:* 1kg of Shea Butter = ₦5,000. Your recipe uses 30g.
 - $(5000 / 1000g) = ₦5$ per gram.
 - $₦5/g * 30g = ₦150$ (Cost of Shea Butter for one lip balm).
 - Add up all ingredients + cost of the jar + cost of the label. This is your **Total Cost**.
2. **Pricing:** Price = Total Cost + Profit Margin. (e.g., Total Cost x 2).
3. **Packaging:** Your jar or bottle is the "first impression." It should be clean, attractive, and appropriate.
4. **Labeling:** A professional label must include:
 - Product Name (e.g., "Peppermint Lip Balm")
 - Net Weight (e.g., 15g)
 - List of Ingredients
 - Your Brand Name / Contact Info

Evaluation questions

1. Why is sanitation the #1 rule in product creation?
2. Why is a digital scale better than using spoons?
3. What is an "anhydrous" product?
4. What is the purpose of "beeswax" in a lip balm?
5. List 3 things that must be on a product label.

Assignment questions

1. **PRACTICAL:** Create one batch (at least 3-5 units) of the product you proposed in Week 6.
2. Create a final, professional label for your product.
3. Calculate your exact "Cost Per Unit" (show your calculations for all ingredients and packaging).
4. Based on your cost, what will your "Selling Price" be?
5. Research the difference between a "Melt and Pour" soap and a "Cold Process" soap. Which is safer for a beginner, and why?

WEEK 9: PRESENTATION OF PROJECTS

TOPIC: GROUP AND INDIVIDUAL PRESENTATIONS

Introduction

This week, you will present your cosmetology entrepreneurship project to the class. This is your chance to "pitch" your product, share your findings from your market survey, and showcase the practical product you created.

A. Presentation skills

A good presentation is as important as a good product.

- **Confidence:** Speak clearly, stand up straight, and make eye contact with your audience.
- **Passion:** Show that you are excited about your product.
- **Clarity:** Be concise. Stick to the most important points.
- **Visuals:** Have your practical product with you. If you have slides or posters, keep them simple.

B. Structure of the presentation (10 minutes)

Follow this structure to give a professional presentation:

1. Introduction (2 mins):

- Introduce your brand/product name.
- State your "Mission Statement."
- Describe your "Target Market."

2. Market research (2 mins):

- Briefly share the *most interesting* results from your market survey.
- (e.g., "We surveyed 20 people and found that 80% of them are unhappy with their current lip balm because it is too waxy.")

3. The product (3 mins):

- Show the class your finished, packaged product.

- Explain the key ingredients and their benefits.
- Explain why your product is *different* or *better* than the competition.

4. Financials (2 mins):

- State your "Cost Per Unit."
- State your final "Selling Price."
- Explain your profit margin.

5. Conclusion (1 min):

- Summarize your project and state your plans for the future (e.g., "Our next step is to create a matching body butter").

C. Peer review and feedback

After each presentation, the class will provide constructive feedback.

- **Constructive feedback:** Is specific, helpful, and polite.
 - *Good:* "Your packaging looks very professional, but your label is hard to read. Maybe use a clearer font?"
 - *Bad:* "Your product is ugly."
- This helps you learn to see your work from a customer's perspective.

Evaluation questions

1. What are the five main sections of the project presentation?
2. Why is it important to show "passion" when presenting?
3. What is "constructive feedback"?
4. What is the difference between "Cost Per Unit" and "Selling Price"?
5. Why should you state your "Target Market" in the introduction?

Assignment questions

1. Prepare your 10-minute presentation. Create any visual aids you need (posters, simple slides, or just your product).
2. Practice your presentation at home until you can do it smoothly.

3. Write a one-page "Reflection" on your project. What was the hardest part? What did you learn? What would you do differently next time?
4. Create a simple "Instagram Launch" post for your product (a photo and a caption).
5. As you watch your classmates present, write down one piece of "constructive feedback" for three different presentations.



WEEK 10: CLIENT CARE AND PSYCHOLOGY

TOPIC: COMMUNICATION, COUNSELLING, CLIENT SATISFACTION

Introduction

As a cosmetologist, you are not just selling a service; you are selling confidence, care, and an experience. Your technical skills will get a client in the chair, but your "soft skills" (communication and client care) are what will make them a loyal, returning customer.

A. The psychology of beauty services

- **It's not just "makeup":** Clients seek beauty services to feel good, confident, relaxed, or to prepare for a major life event. Your job is part-artist, part-therapist.
- **The power of touch:** A gentle, confident touch (e.g., during a facial massage or makeup application) builds trust and makes the client feel cared for.
- **The consultation as counselling:** The consultation is a "counselling" session. You must diagnose their *needs*, not just listen to their *wants*.
 - *Client says:* "I want this super-skinny Instagram eyebrow."
 - *You "counsel":* "That is a beautiful look. I see that your natural brow is much fuller. How about we try a shape that is a bit fuller, which is very modern and will suit your face shape perfectly?"

B. Communication skills

1. Active listening:

- Listen to *understand*, not just to wait for your turn to talk.
- Make eye contact, nod, and repeat their concerns back to them ("So, what I'm hearing is you are worried about looking too 'oily' for your event?").

2. Open-ended questions:

- These are questions that cannot be answered with "yes" or "no." They make the client talk.
- *Bad (Closed):* "Do you want red lipstick?"

- *Good (Open)*: "What kind of looks do you normally go for?" or "How do you want to *feel* at your event?"

3. Managing expectations:

- Be honest. Do not promise a miracle.
- *Client shows a filtered photo*: "I love this! This is a beautiful inspiration. Please be aware that this photo is heavily edited, so the skin texture will look different in real life, but we can definitely achieve this same *style*."

C. Handling difficult clients

Complaints are a chance to prove your professionalism. Use the **H.E.A.T.** method.

- **H - Hear them out**: Let them talk. Do not interrupt, even if you disagree.
- **E - Empathize**: Show you understand their feelings. "I understand how frustrating it is when the look isn't what you pictured."
- **A - Apologize**: Apologize sincerely. "I am so sorry that you are not happy with this."
- **T - Take action**: Offer a specific solution. "Let's fix it right now. Would you prefer we try a different lip colour, or shall we soften the eyeshadow? I will not let you leave until you love it."

D. Client satisfaction and retention

- **Client records**: Keep a small card or file for each client (skin type, allergies, products they liked, personal notes - e.g., "daughter is in JSS1").
- **Confidentiality**: The salon is a private space. Do not gossip *to* your clients or *about* your clients.
- **Go the extra mile**: Offer a glass of water. Send a "Thank you" text. A small effort makes a big difference.

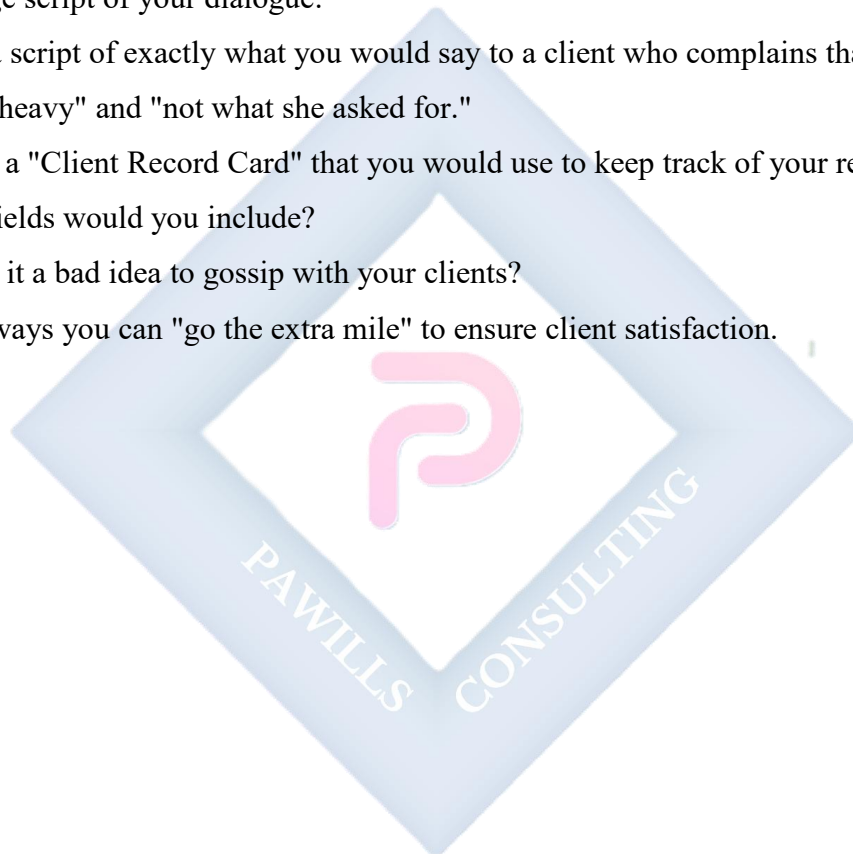
Evaluation questions

1. Why is a consultation described as a "counselling" session?
2. What is "active listening"?

3. Give an example of an "open-ended question."
4. What does the "H.E.A.T." method stand for?
5. Why is client confidentiality important?

Assignment questions

1. Pair up and role-play a client consultation. One person is a difficult client (e.g., "indecisive" or "wants something that won't work"). The other is the cosmetologist. Write a 1-page script of your dialogue.
2. Write a script of exactly what you would say to a client who complains that her makeup is "too heavy" and "not what she asked for."
3. Design a "Client Record Card" that you would use to keep track of your regular clients. What fields would you include?
4. Why is it a bad idea to gossip with your clients?
5. List 5 ways you can "go the extra mile" to ensure client satisfaction.



WEEK 11-13: REVISION & EXAMS

- **WEEK 11:** Comprehensive review of all topics from Week 1 to Week 10. Focus on the practical business proposal and client psychology.
- **WEEK 12:** First Term Examination (Theory).
- **WEEK 13:** First Term Examination (Practical - e.g., "Present your business project" or "Conduct a mock client consultation").



SS3 BEAUTY AND COSMETOLOGY LESSON NOTES

SECOND TERM

WEEK 1: ADVANCED SPA SERVICES

TOPIC: BODY SCRUBS, WRAPS, HOLISTIC THERAPIES

Introduction

Advanced spa services move beyond the face and hands to treat the entire body. These services are designed to exfoliate, hydrate, detoxify, and relax the client. They combine cosmetic science (products) with holistic well-being (the experience) and are a highly profitable addition to any spa menu.

A. Body scrubs (exfoliation)

1. **DEFINITION:** A body scrub (or body polish) is a spa treatment that exfoliates the skin on the body, leaving it smooth, soft, and refreshed. It removes the outermost layer of dead skin cells.
2. **BENEFITS:**
 - **Exfoliation:** Removes dead skin cells, revealing softer skin underneath.
 - **Circulation:** The scrubbing motion stimulates blood flow and lymphatic drainage.
 - **Product absorption:** Allows lotions and oils to penetrate more deeply.
 - **Appearance:** Can help improve the appearance of clogged pores and skin texture.
3. **TYPES OF EXFOLIANTS:**
 - **Sugar scrubs:** Sugar granules are rounder and less abrasive, making them gentle. Sugar is also a natural "humectant," meaning it draws moisture to the skin. Ideal for sensitive skin.
 - **Salt scrubs (e.g., Sea Salt, Epsom Salt):** Salt granules are more angular and abrasive. They are excellent for deep exfoliation and have detoxifying properties. Ideal for rough areas like feet and elbows.

- **Herbal/Grain scrubs:** Using materials like oatmeal, coffee grounds, or rice bran. Coffee is popular for its "cellulite-reducing" (stimulating) properties.

4. **CONTRAINDICATIONS (DO NOT PERFORM):**

- Sunburn, open wounds, cuts, or rashes.
- Severe skin conditions (e.g., active eczema, psoriasis).
- High blood pressure (get doctor's permission, avoid vigorous massage).

B. Body wraps

1. **DEFINITION:** A body wrap involves applying a therapeutic mask to the body and then wrapping the client in plastic or warm blankets for 20-30 minutes. This allows the ingredients to penetrate the skin.

2. **PROCEDURE:**

- Step 1: Often begins with a dry brushing or a light body scrub to exfoliate.
- Step 2: The mask (e.g., clay, mud, algae) is applied from shoulders to ankles.
- Step 3: The client is wrapped in plastic wrap and/or warm thermal blankets.
- Step 4: The client rests for 20-30 minutes.
- Step 5: The wrap is removed, and the client showers off the product.
- Step 6: A hydrating lotion is applied.

3. **TYPES AND BENEFITS:**

- **Detoxifying wraps (e.g., Clay, Seaweed, Mud):** These wraps use "absorbent" ingredients to draw impurities and toxins from the skin.
- **Hydrating wraps (e.g., Aloe Vera, Shea Butter):** These are rich, creamy masks designed to heal and moisturize dry, dehydrated, or sunburnt skin.
- **"Slimming" wraps (Herbal/Compression):** These are *temporary* results. They work by causing water loss (sweat) or by compressing the tissue, which makes the client look and feel temporarily slimmer. They do not remove fat.

C. Holistic therapies (the mind-body connection)

1. **DEFINITION:** "Holistic" means treating the "whole" person (mind, body, and spirit), not just their physical symptoms. In a spa context, it means creating an experience that reduces stress and improves well-being.
2. **AROMATHERAPY:**
 - **What it is:** The use of "essential oils" (concentrated plant extracts) for their therapeutic benefits. The oils are either inhaled (diffused) or absorbed through the skin (mixed with a carrier oil like coconut or almond oil).
 - **Common oils and uses:**
 - **Lavender:** Calming, relaxing, good for sleep.
 - **Peppermint:** Energizing, cooling, good for headaches.
 - **Eucalyptus:** Decongestant, purifying (good for steam rooms).
 - **Lemon/Orange:** Uplifting, refreshing, mood-boosting.
 - **Tea Tree:** Antiseptic, antibacterial (good for acne).
 - **Safety:** Essential oils are *highly concentrated* and **must** be diluted in a carrier oil before being applied to the skin.
3. **OTHER HOLISTIC CONCEPTS (INTRODUCTION):**
 - **Reflexology:** A technique of applying pressure to specific "reflex points" on the feet and hands that are believed to correspond to organs and systems in the body.
 - **Hot stone massage:** Using smooth, heated basalt stones to warm and relax the muscles.

Evaluation questions

1. What is the main difference between a salt scrub and a sugar scrub?
2. List three main benefits of a body scrub.
3. What is a "contraindication"? Name one for a body wrap.
4. What does "holistic" mean?
5. What is aromatherapy, and why must essential oils be diluted?

Assignment questions

1. Describe the full, step-by-step procedure for a professional body wrap.

2. What is the main purpose of a "detoxifying" wrap compared to a "hydrating" wrap?
3. You have a client who is stressed and has dry skin. Design a 1-hour "Holistic Spa Package" for her, describing the services and aromatherapy oils you would use.
4. Create a simple recipe for a DIY sugar scrub. List the (a) Exfoliant, (b) Carrier Oil, (c) Scent, and (d) benefits of each.
5. Explain the *temporary* effect of a "slimming" wrap. What is it actually removing from the body?



WEEK 2: GLOBAL BEAUTY STANDARDS

TOPIC: CULTURAL PERCEPTIONS OF BEAUTY; DIVERSITY

Introduction

What is "beauty"? The answer changes dramatically depending on *where* and *when* you ask. Beauty standards are not universal; they are cultural constructs. As a global cosmetologist, it is essential to understand and respect this diversity to cater to clients from all backgrounds.

A. Cultural perceptions of beauty (examples)

1. Skin tone:

- **Many Western cultures (e.g., USA, Europe):** A tan is often associated with health, leisure, and wealth (having time to be in the sun).
- **Many Asian and African cultures:** Fairer or lighter skin is traditionally associated with wealth (not having to work in the fields) and is highly desirable. This fuels a massive market for skin-lightening and "brightening" products.

2. Body shape:

- **Western media (mainstream):** Often promotes a "slim" or "slim-thick" ideal.
- **Many African cultures (e.g., Nigeria, South Africa):** A fuller, more curvaceous figure is often celebrated as a sign of health, fertility, and prosperity.

3. Facial features:

- **Kayan Tribe (Myanmar):** Long necks, elongated by wearing brass coils, are seen as the ultimate sign of female beauty.
- **South Korea:** A small, "V-shaped" face, pale skin, and large "double-lidded" eyes are the dominant standard, fueling a world-leading plastic surgery industry.
- **Maasai Tribe (Kenya):** Elongated earlobes (stretched with beads) and shaved heads for women are traditional signs of beauty.

B. The evolution of beauty standards

Beauty ideals are not static; they change over time.

- **Example (Western):**
 - **1950s:** Curvy, hourglass figures (e.g., Marilyn Monroe).
 - **1990s:** Extremely thin, "heroin chic" look (e.g., Kate Moss).
 - **2020s:** A move towards celebrating more athletic, strong, or diverse body types.

C. Diversity and inclusivity in cosmetology

1. **THE "WHY":** The beauty industry has historically ignored or underserved people of colour. A modern cosmetologist *must* be inclusive.
2. **MAKEUP:**
 - **The "Fenty Effect":** When Fenty Beauty launched in 2017 with 40 shades of foundation, it revolutionized the industry. It proved that there was a huge, underserved market.
 - **As a MUA:** You *must* have a kit that can cater to *all* skin tones, from the lightest albino skin to the deepest ebony skin. This includes understanding undertones (warm, cool, neutral) in all skin depths.
3. **HAIR:**
 - The "Natural Hair Movement" has been a powerful cultural shift, encouraging black women to embrace their natural hair textures (coils, kinks, curls) rather than chemically relaxing them.
 - **As a stylist:** You must be trained to care for *all* hair types, not just straight or relaxed hair. This includes cutting, colouring, and styling coily hair.
4. **MARKETING:**
 - Modern brands are now using models of all races, ages, body sizes, and abilities. Inclusivity is not just a moral good; it is a smart business strategy.

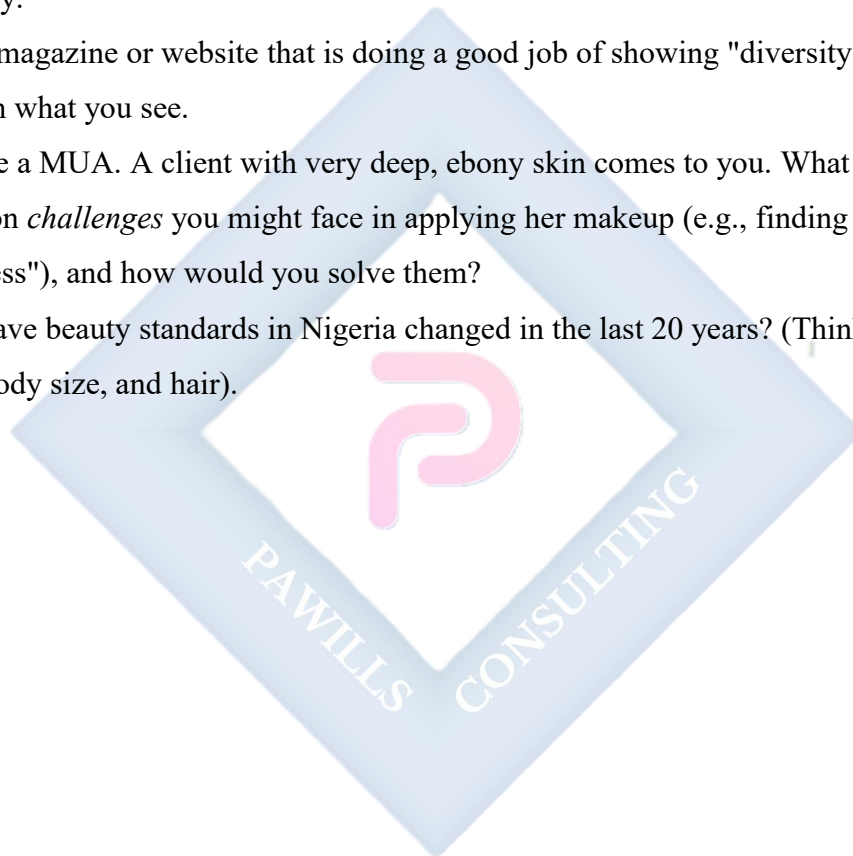
Evaluation questions

1. Give one example of a cultural perception of beauty that is different from your own.
2. What is the "Fenty Effect"?
3. Why is it important for a makeup artist to understand "undertones"?
4. What was the "Natural Hair Movement"?

5. Why should a salon professional be trained in all hair types?

Assignment questions

1. "Beauty is a cultural construct." What do you think this sentence means? Explain in one paragraph.
2. Research the beauty standards of one specific culture (e.g., ancient Egypt, modern Brazil, traditional Japan). Write a short report (2-3 paragraphs) on what is considered beautiful and why.
3. Find a magazine or website that is doing a good job of showing "diversity" in its models. Explain what you see.
4. You are a MUA. A client with very deep, ebony skin comes to you. What are the common *challenges* you might face in applying her makeup (e.g., finding shades, "ashiness"), and how would you solve them?
5. How have beauty standards in Nigeria changed in the last 20 years? (Think about skin tone, body size, and hair).



WEEK 3: COSMETIC CHEMISTRY II

TOPIC: PRESERVATION, FRAGRANCE, SAFETY TESTING

Introduction

In Term 1, we made simple, anhydrous (water-free) products. But to create professional, water-based products (like lotions, creams, serums), you must understand preservation. This week, we dive deeper into the science of keeping products safe, making them smell good, and proving they work.

A. Preservation (the most critical component)

1. **WHY?** Any product that contains **water** is a "buffet" for bacteria, mould, and yeast. Without a preservative, a water-based cream would be a furry, mouldy mess in days.
2. **PRESERVATIVES:** These are ingredients that kill (or stop the growth of) microbes.
 - **Parabens (e.g., Methylparaben, Propylparaben):** Excellent, cheap, and very effective. They have been controversial, but most scientific bodies (like the EU, FDA) have repeatedly proven them safe at the low levels used in cosmetics.
 - **Formaldehyde-releasers:** (e.g., DMDM Hydantoin). Very effective, but unpopular due to the "formaldehyde" name.
 - **Phenoxyethanol:** A very common, gentle, and effective modern preservative.
 - **Natural/Alternative:** Ingredients like Vitamin E, Grapefruit Seed Extract, and Essential Oils are **NOT** strong enough to preserve a water-based product. They are *antioxidants* (stop oil from going rancid) but not *antimicrobials*.
3. **"PRESERVATIVE-FREE" PRODUCTS:**
 - **Anhydrous:** The product contains no water (e.g., body butter, lip balm, face oil).
 - **Single-use:** The product is used once and discarded (e.g., sheet mask).
 - **Airless pump:** The packaging does not let air or fingers in.

B. Fragrance

1. **FUNCTION:** To provide a pleasant scent and mask the smell of raw ingredients.

2. TYPES:

- **Essential Oils (EOs):** Natural. Extracted from plants (e.g., lavender, lemon). They are volatile and can have therapeutic properties (aromatherapy), but are also common allergens.
- **Fragrance Oils (FOs) / "Parfum":** Synthetic. Created in a lab. They are cheaper, more stable, and offer a wider range of scents (e.g., "ocean breeze," "strawberry"). "Parfum" on a label can be a blend of 100+ different chemicals.

3. LABELING:

- **"Fragrance-Free":** No fragrances (natural or synthetic) have been added. The product may still have a smell from its raw ingredients.
- **"Unscented":** A synthetic fragrance has been added to *mask* and *neutralize* the smell of the raw ingredients, resulting in no scent.
- **Allergens:** In the EU, common fragrance allergens (like Linalool, Geraniol) must be listed separately on the ingredients list.

C. Safety and marketing claims

1. **Patch test:** The *only* way to know if a client is allergic. Place a small amount of the new product (e.g., hair dye, new facial cream) on their inner elbow or behind the ear. Wait 24-48 hours. If there is no redness, itching, or swelling, it is safe to use.

2. MARKETING TERMS:

- **"Dermatologically Tested":** The product was tested on human skin, supervised by a dermatologist. It means *very little* about its effectiveness.
- **"Hypoallergenic":** The product is *less likely* to cause an allergic reaction. It is **not** a guarantee. Often, it just means "fragrance-free."
- **"Non-Comedogenic":** The product is formulated with ingredients that are not *known* to clog pores. This is important for oily/acne-prone skin.
- **"Vegan":** Contains no animal products or by-products (e.g., no beeswax, honey, or carmine).
- **"Cruelty-Free":** The product (and its ingredients) were not tested on animals. (Look for the "Leaping Bunny" logo).

Evaluation questions

1. Why is a preservative absolutely necessary in a product containing water?
2. What is an "anhydrous" product?
3. What is the main difference between an "Essential Oil" and a "Fragrance Oil"?
4. Explain the difference between "Fragrance-Free" and "Unscented."
5. What does "Non-Comedogenic" mean, and for what skin type is it important?

Assignment questions

1. Go to a store (or look online) and find a cosmetic product (like a lotion or face wash). Write down the full ingredients list. Identify (a) the preservative(s) and (b) the fragrance ingredient(s).
2. Describe, in detail, how to perform a "patch test" for a new hair dye client.
3. Why are "parabens" controversial, and what is the scientific consensus on their safety? (Requires brief research).
4. A client wants to buy a "100% natural" face cream made of just water, shea butter, and lavender oil. As a cosmetologist, explain the safety risks to her.
5. What is the difference between a "Cruelty-Free" product and a "Vegan" product? Can a product be one but not the other?

WEEK 4: HEALTH AND SAFETY REGULATIONS

TOPIC: SALON HYGIENE; GOVERNMENT REGULATIONS

Introduction

A beautiful salon with dirty tools is not a professional salon; it is a public health hazard. As a cosmetologist, you have a legal and ethical duty to protect your clients (and yourself) from the spread of infectious diseases. This requires following strict hygiene protocols and understanding the laws that govern our industry.

A. Salon hygiene (advanced)

1. Sanitation vs. Disinfection vs. Sterilization (Review):

- **Sanitation:** Washing with soap and water. Removes visible dirt.
- **Disinfection:** Kills *most* pathogens (bacteria, viruses, fungi). **This is the minimum standard for all salon tools.**
- **Sterilization:** Kills *all* microbial life, including spores. **This is mandatory for any tool that might draw blood.**

2. DISINFECTION (FOR "NON-CRITICAL" TOOLS):

- Applies to combs, brushes, nail files, clippers, bowls, etc.
- **Procedure:** (1) Wash with soap and water to remove debris. (2) Fully immerse in an EPA-approved disinfectant (like **Barbicide**) for the full time on the label (usually 10 minutes). (3) Rinse and store in a clean, dry, covered container.

3. STERILIZATION (FOR "CRITICAL" TOOLS):

- Applies to tools like metal cuticle nippers, extraction tools, or (in other fields) tattoo needles.
- **Method:** An **Autoclave**. This machine uses high-pressure steam (like a pressure cooker) to achieve 100% sterilization. It is the gold standard of safety.

4. BLOOD-SPILL PROTOCOL (ESSENTIAL):

- If you accidentally cut a client (e.g., during a manicure):
- **Step 1:** Stop the service immediately.
- **Step 2:** Put on gloves (if not already wearing them).

- **Step 3:** Give the client a styptic (antiseptic) and a plaster/Band-Aid.
- **Step 4:** Discard *all* single-use items (cotton, file) in a sealed plastic bag.
- **Step 5:** Immerse all metal tools in disinfectant (or autoclave).
- **Step 6:** Clean and disinfect the entire work station.

B. Waste disposal

- **General waste:** Hair, paper, non-contaminated items.
- **Contaminated waste:** Anything with blood or bodily fluids (e.g., cotton from a blood spill, wax strips). Must be double-bagged and sealed.
- **Sharps waste:** Blades (e.g., from a razor), needles. **Must** go into a designated "Sharps Container."

C. Government regulations (Nigeria)

1. **NAFDAC (National Agency for Food and Drug Administration and Control):**
 - **For Products:** If you make and sell your own cosmetic products (like in your Term 1 project), you must register them with NAFDAC to legally sell them in Nigeria. They test the product for safety.
 - **For Salons:** NAFDAC also regulates imported cosmetics, ensuring they are safe and not counterfeit.
2. **SON (Standards Organisation of Nigeria):**
 - Sets the minimum quality *standards* for all products, including cosmetics (SONCAP).
3. **State and Local Government (e.g., Ministry of Health):**
 - These are the bodies that conduct *routine inspections* of salons and spas.
 - They check for:
 - General cleanliness and sanitation.
 - Proper waste disposal.
 - Valid business permits.
 - Fire safety equipment.

D. Professional ethics

- **Client confidentiality:** What is said in the salon, stays in the salon. Do not gossip.
- **Scope of practice:** Do not perform services you are not trained or certified for. Do not "diagnose" a medical condition (e.g., "That looks like eczema"). Instead, *refer* them to a doctor ("I cannot perform this service; I recommend you see a dermatologist").

Evaluation questions

1. What is the difference between disinfection and sterilization?
2. What is the minimum standard of hygiene for a comb?
3. What is an "autoclave" used for?
4. What is the first step in a blood-spill protocol?
5. What is the role of NAFDAC in the beauty industry?

Assignment questions

1. Describe the step-by-step "Blood-Spill Protocol" in full.
2. You see a co-worker finish with a client and drop their comb and scissors back into the drawer without cleaning them. What do you do or say, and why is this dangerous?
3. What is a "sharps container," and what items must go in it?
4. A client asks you to "cut off" a mole they don't like. How do you respond, and what is this an example of ("Scope of Practice")?
5. Research the process for registering a new cosmetic product (like a soap) with NAFDAC. Write 1-2 paragraphs on what is required.

WEEK 5: MIDTERM TEST

This week is for the midterm test, which will cover all content from Weeks 1-4.

- **Topics:** Advanced Spa Services (scrubs, wraps, aromatherapy), Global Beauty Standards, Cosmetic Chemistry (preservatives, fragrance, safety), and Health & Safety Regulations (hygiene, NAFDAC).



WEEK 6: DIGITAL MARKETING FOR BEAUTY BUSINESS

TOPIC: SOCIAL MEDIA BRANDING; ONLINE BOOKING SYSTEMS

Introduction

Today, your salon's "front door" is not on the street; it's on a phone screen. A strong digital presence is no longer optional—it is essential for a modern beauty business. It is how you build a brand, find new clients, and manage your appointments.

A. Social media branding

1. **YOUR "BRAND IDENTITY":** This is the "feeling" of your business.
 - **Visuals:** Your logo, brand colours, and font. These must be *consistent* across all profiles.
 - **Voice:** How do you "sound" online? Are you fun and trendy? Or calm, luxurious, and professional?
2. **CHOOSING YOUR PLATFORM:**
 - **Instagram:** The most important. It is highly visual. Perfect for "Before & After" photos, video reels (tutorials, transformations), and building a portfolio.
 - **TikTok:** Excellent for short, engaging video content. Great for showing personality, quick tips, and participating in trends.
 - **Facebook:** Good for building a "community," sharing longer posts, and collecting client reviews.
3. **CONTENT STRATEGY (WHAT TO POST):**
 - **The 80/20 Rule:** 80% of your content should be **Value** (helpful, entertaining), and 20% should be **Promotion** (sales, "book now").
 - **Value Content:**
 - **Before & Afters:** Your most powerful selling tool. (Always get client permission!).
 - **Tutorials:** A "Reel" showing how you do a "smokey eye" or a "perfect manicure."
 - **Tips & Tricks:** "3 ways to make your makeup last all day."

- **Testimonials:** Share screenshots of good client reviews.
- **Behind-the-Scenes:** Show your clean workspace, you unboxing new products.
- **Hashtags:** Use a mix of broad (e.g., #makeup), specific (e.g., #lagosmua), and branded (e.g., #BimpesBeauty) hashtags.

B. Online booking systems

1. WHY USE ONE?

- **Professionalism:** It looks more professional than "DM to book."
- **Efficiency:** It saves you time. No more back-and-forth messages.
- **24/7 Availability:** Clients can book at 2 AM.
- **Automated reminders:** Sends text/email reminders to clients, which *dramatically* reduces "no-shows."
- **Deposits:** You can require a deposit to book, which protects your time.

2. POPULAR SYSTEMS:

- **Calendly:** Simple, often free for basic use. Good for one-on-one appointments.
- **Acuity Scheduling / Squarespace Scheduling:** A very popular, powerful tool for salons.
- **Social Media Tools:** Instagram and Facebook now have built-in "Book Now" buttons that can link to your system.

C. Managing your online reputation

- **Reviews are everything.** Encourage happy clients to leave a review on Google or Facebook.
- **Responding to comments:**
 - **Good comments:** "Thank you so much! It was a pleasure."
 - **Bad comments:** Do *not* delete them (unless they are spam). Respond publicly and professionally. "We are so sorry you had this experience. Please check your DMs so we can resolve this." (Then, handle the problem *privately*).

Evaluation questions

1. What is a "brand identity" on social media?
2. What is the "80/20 Rule" of content?
3. Why are "Before & After" photos so powerful?
4. List three benefits of using an online booking system.
5. How should you handle a negative public comment?

Assignment questions

1. Create a "Brand Identity" for your dream salon. Choose a (a) Name, (b) Colour Palette (3 colours), and (c) Brand Voice (3 words, e.g., "Luxurious, Calm, Professional").
2. Create a 1-week "Content Calendar" for your salon's Instagram. (List 7 post ideas, one for each day).
3. Write a professional "call to action" caption for a beautiful "Before & After" bridal makeup photo.
4. Research two online booking systems (e.g., Calendly, Acuity). Compare their features and pricing for a small salon.
5. What is a "hashtag strategy"? Why is it better to use a mix of broad and specific hashtags?

WEEK 7: MIDTERM BREAK



WEEK 8: JOB OPPORTUNITIES IN THE BEAUTY INDUSTRY

TOPIC: MAKEUP ARTIST, COSMETOLOGIST, SKINCARE CONSULTANT, NAIL TECHNICIAN

Introduction

A cosmetology certification is a gateway to a wide and growing industry. Your skills can be applied in many different environments, from self-employment (freelancing) to working for a global brand. This week, we explore the most common career paths.

A. The "artist" paths

1. Makeup artist (MUA):

- **Bridal MUA:** Specializes in weddings. (Pros: Good money. Cons: High stress, weekend work).
- **Editorial/Fashion MUA:** Works on photo shoots, runway shows. (Pros: Highly creative. Cons: Very competitive, may start for free - "TFP").
- **Retail MUA:** Works at a makeup counter (e.g., MAC, Maybelline). (Pros: Steady salary, free products, good training. Cons: Sales-focused).
- **Film/TV MUA:** Works on movie sets. (Pros: Union pay. Cons: Long hours, requires special skills like "special effects").

2. Nail technician:

- **Salon Tech:** Performs manicures, pedicures, gel, and acrylics.
- **Nail Artist:** A specialist in complex, artistic designs.
- **Brand Educator:** Works for a brand (e.g., OPI) and trains other techs.

3. Hairstylist / Cosmetologist:

- **General Stylist:** "Jack-of-all-trades" (cut, colour, relaxer, styling).
- **Colourist:** A specialist in dyeing, highlights, and balayage.
- **Loctician:** A specialist in starting and maintaining locs.
- **Extension/Wig Specialist:** Focuses on weaving, wig making, and installations.

B. The "consultant" and "therapist" paths

1. Skincare consultant / Esthetician:

- **Spa Esthetician:** Performs facials, body treatments, waxing.
- **Medical Esthetician:** Works in a dermatologist's office or "MedSpa." Performs more advanced treatments like chemical peels, laser hair removal, and microneedling (with special certification).

2. Beauty blogger / Vlogger / Influencer:

- A full-time content creator. (Pros: Fame, free products, brand deals. Cons: Unstable income, always "on," high-pressure).

C. The "business" paths

1. Salon / Spa owner:

- Manages the entire business: staff, finances, marketing, inventory. Requires strong business skills, not just technical skills.

2. Brand representative / Educator:

- Works for a large company (e.g., L'Oréal, a local brand). Travels to salons to sell products and train other cosmetologists.

3. Product developer:

- Works with cosmetic chemists in a lab to create and test new products.

Evaluation questions

1. What is the main difference between an "Editorial MUA" and a "Retail MUA"?
2. What is a "Medical Esthetician"?
3. What is a "Loctician"?
4. List three different specialist roles within "Hairstyling."
5. What is the primary role of a "Brand Educator"?

Assignment questions

1. Of all the careers listed, which one interests you the most, and why? (1 paragraph).
2. Compare the "Pros and Cons" of being a "Freelance Bridal MUA" vs. a "Retail MUA."

3. What skills, other than technical skills, does a "Salon Owner" need to be successful? (List at least 5).
4. What is a "TFP" ("Trade For Print") arrangement, and which career path is it most common in?
5. Research the path to becoming a "Medical Esthetician." What additional training or certifications are required beyond a basic cosmetology license?



WEEK 9: CAREER PREPARATION

TOPIC: CV WRITING; INTERVIEW SKILLS; FREELANCING

Introduction

Having great skills is only half the battle. You also need to be able to *sell* those skills to an employer or client. This week, we focus on the professional tools you need: a powerful CV, confident interview skills, and the basics of freelancing.

A. CV (Curriculum Vitae) writing

Your CV is a 1-page summary of your professional self. It must be clean, professional, and easy to read.

- **Key sections:**

1. **Contact info:** Name, Phone Number, Professional Email, Instagram Handle (if it's a portfolio).
2. **Professional summary:** A 2-3 sentence "pitch." (e.g., "Certified cosmetologist with 2+ years of experience specializing in natural hair care and bridal makeup. Passionate about client satisfaction and hygiene.").
3. **Skills (The most important part!):** Use bullet points.
 - *Examples:* Manicures & Pedicures, Gel & Acrylic Application, Facials & Skin Analysis, Bridal Makeup, Chemical Relaxers, Knotless Braiding, Salon Sanitation & Safety.
4. **Certifications:** (e.g., "Diploma in Cosmetology, [Your School], 2025").
5. **Experience:**
 - If you have formal work: (Job Title, Salon Name, Dates).
 - If you are new: Use "Freelance Experience." List your projects, even unpaid ones. (e.g., "Freelance MUA, 2024-Present: Provided bridal and event makeup for 15+ clients," "Managed @BimpesBeauty Instagram portfolio").

B. Interview skills

1. **Appearance:** Your interview *is* your "trade test." Show up looking like a beauty professional: clean, neat hair; subtle, clean makeup; clean, trimmed nails; and a professional outfit.
2. **Communication:**
 - **Confidence:** Firm handshake, good eye contact, smile.
 - **Be prepared:** Research the salon *before* you go.
 - **Answer common questions:**
 - "Tell me about yourself." (Use your Professional Summary).
 - "Why do you want to work here?" ("I admire your salon's focus on natural hair...")
 - "How do you handle a difficult client?" (Use the H.E.A.T. method from Term 1).
3. **The "Trade Test":**
 - Be prepared to *prove* your skills.
 - They may ask you to perform a manicure, a makeup application, or a hair blowout on a model or staff member.
 - Bring your own basic, *clean* kit unless they state otherwise.

C. Freelancing (being your own boss)

1. **The setup:**
 - **Register a business name** (with the CAC - Corporate Affairs Commission).
 - **Get a professional email** and phone number.
 - **Create a contract:** A simple document that outlines your services, price, deposit, and cancellation policy. (Crucial for bridal work!).
2. **Finding clients:**
 - **Referrals:** Your #1 source. Do a great job on one client, and they will tell 5 friends.
 - **Social media:** Post your work consistently.
 - **Networking:** Partner with photographers, event planners, and hairstylists.

3. The finances (the hard part):

- **Set your prices:** Calculate your costs (products, transport) and add your profit.
- **Manage your money:** You must save money for taxes, to buy new products, and for "slow months" when you have no clients.

Evaluation questions

1. What is a "Professional Summary" on a CV?
2. Why is the "Skills" section so important on a cosmetologist's CV?
3. What is a "Trade Test"?
4. Why is a "contract" essential for a freelancer?
5. What is the "H.E.A.T." method for handling complaints?

Assignment questions

1. **PRACTICAL:** Write your own professional, one-page CV using the template from this lesson.
2. Write a script for how you would answer the interview question: "Tell me about yourself." (Should be 3-4 sentences).
3. Write a script for how you would answer: "A client is 30 minutes late for her appointment, which will make you late for your next client. What do you do?"
4. List 3 "Pros" and 3 "Cons" of being a freelancer.
5. Create a simple "Freelance Contract" template for a bridal makeup service. (Include client name, date, price, deposit, and cancellation policy).

WEEK 10: WAEC/NECO COSMETOLOGY SYLLABUS REVISION

TOPIC: INTENSIVE PREPARATION

Introduction

This week, we begin our final, intensive review for the external SSCE exams. We will focus on the entire 3-year syllabus, with a special emphasis on frequently tested, high-value topics.

A. Structure of the exam (recap)

- **Paper 1 (Objectives):** Multiple-choice questions (e.g., 50 questions, 1 hour). Tests your "fact" knowledge.
- **Paper 2 (Theory/Essay):** Requires detailed written answers (e.g., answer 4 out of 6 questions, 2 hours). Tests your "understanding."
- **Paper 3 (Practical):** Identification of specimens, tools, and data analysis. May involve performing a basic service.

B. "Hot topics" for revision (highly tested areas)

1. HYGIENE AND SAFETY (ALWAYS TESTED):

- **Definitions:** Sanitation, Disinfection, Sterilization, Antiseptic, Disinfectant.
- **Contraindications:** What they are, and examples for facials, waxing, and nails (e.g., fungus, ringworm, open wounds).
- **Blood-Spill Protocol:** Must know this step-by-step.

2. ANATOMY (SKIN, HAIR, NAILS):

- **Skin:** The 3 layers (Epidermis, Dermis, Subcutaneous) and their functions.
- **Hair:** The 3 parts (Cuticle, Cortex, Medulla). The role of "disulfide bonds" in the cortex.
- **Nails:** The 6 main parts (Matrix, Nail Bed, Nail Plate, Cuticle, Lunula, Free Edge).

3. SKIN CARE:

- **Skin Types:** Identifying (Dry, Oily, Normal, Combo) and their characteristics.
- **Facial Procedure:** The 10-step process (Cleanse, Analyze, Exfoliate...).

- **Massage Movements:** Effleurage (stroking), Petrissage (kneading).

4. HAIR CHEMISTRY:

- **The pH Scale:** What is "acid," what is "alkaline."
- **Relaxers:** Sodium Hydroxide (Lye) vs. Calcium Hydroxide (No-Lye). They are *alkaline* and *break* disulfide bonds.
- **Perms:** Ammonium Thioglycolate. They *break* and *re-form* disulfide bonds.

5. MAKEUP AND BUSINESS:

- **Tools:** Know all your brushes (foundation, concealer, powder, blush, eyeshadow blender).
- **Business:** "Qualities of a cosmetologist" (e.g., professional, hygienic, good communicator).

C. Exam strategy

- **Theory:** Read the verb. "List" means list. "Explain" or "Describe" means you must write in full sentences and give details.
- **Practical:** Bring a clean, professional kit. Look at the specimens carefully.
- **Objectives:** Answer the ones you know first. Go back to the hard ones.

Evaluation questions

1. What is the "Matrix" of the nail, and what is its function?
2. What is the "Cortex" of the hair, and what bonds are found there?
3. What is "Petrissage"?
4. Are relaxers "acidic" or "alkaline"?
5. What is a "contraindication"?

Assignment questions

1. Draw and label the 3 layers of the skin.
2. Draw and label the 6 main parts of the nail.
3. Create a table comparing "Lye Relaxers" and "No-Lye Relaxers."

4. Get a WAEC/NECO past question paper. Answer all questions from the "Hygiene" and "Skin Care" sections.
5. Write out the 10 steps of a classic European facial.



WEEK 11-12: REVISION & EXAMINATION

- **WEEK 11:** Final, intensive revision of all SS1, SS2, and SS3 topics. Focus on practicing with past questions (objectives, theory, and practical).
- **WEEK 12:** Mock SSCE Examination (Theory and Practical).



SS3 BEAUTY AND COSMETOLOGY LESSON NOTES

THIRD TERM

WEEK 1: PRACTICAL SESSIONS

TOPIC: MAKEUP, HAIR, NAIL, AND SKIN CARE PRACTICALS

Introduction

This term, we move almost entirely from theory to practical application. This week is dedicated to high-level, timed practicals designed to simulate a professional salon environment and prepare you for your external exams. The focus is on **speed, hygiene, precision, and client care**. You will rotate through different stations.

A. Station 1: Professional makeup application

- **OBJECTIVE:** To complete a full "event" makeup look (e.g., bridal or flash photography) on a model or mannequin head.
- **TIME LIMIT:** 1 hour.
- **KEY SKILLS TO DEMONSTRATE:**
 - **Hygiene:** A clean station, sanitized brushes, and use of a palette (no double-dipping).
 - **Consultation:** A 2-minute "mock" consultation to determine the client's "look."
 - **Skin Prep:** Cleansing, toning, and priming for the skin type.
 - **Application:** Flawless foundation matching (undertones), seamless blending, appropriate contouring (no SPF for flash photography), and symmetrical brow/eyeliner application.
 - **Finishing:** False eyelash application and a final setting spray.

B. Station 2: Advanced hair care service

- **OBJECTIVE:** To correctly perform a chemical relaxer "retouch" on a mannequin head (or a mock application with conditioner).

- **TIME LIMIT:** 45 minutes (for application and processing).
- **KEY SKILLS TO DEMONSTRATE:**
 - **Analysis & Prep:** Sectioning the hair (4 quadrants), and applying a protective base cream to the scalp and previously relaxed hair.
 - **Application:** Applying the relaxer *only* to the new growth (virgin hair), starting from the most resistant area (usually the crown/back).
 - **Technique:** No "overlapping" onto previously relaxed hair. Smooth, fast application.
 - **Timing:** Knowing when to rinse, based on hair texture.
 - **Completion:** Mock rinse, followed by a thorough mock *neutralization* (the most critical step to stop chemical damage).

C. Station 3: Advanced nail technology

- **OBJECTIVE:** To perform a full "Deluxe Spa Pedicure" OR a full set of acrylic/gel nail extensions.
- **TIME LIMIT:** 1 hour 15 minutes.
- **KEY SKILLS TO DEMONSTRATE (PEDICURE):**
 - **Hygiene:** Sanitized foot bath, sterilized metal tools (nippers, pushers).
 - **Procedure:** Correct soak, nail trimming/shaping, cuticle care (pushing, nipping safely), exfoliation (scrub), callus reduction (foot file), and leg/foot massage.
 - **Polish:** Clean, streak-free polish application.
- **KEY SKILLS TO DEMONSTRATE (EXTENSIONS):**
 - **Nail Prep:** Sanitizing, cuticle pushing, and gently buffing the nail plate to remove shine.
 - **Application:** Correctly sizing and applying tips (or forms).
 - **Build:** Correct liquid-to-powder ratio ("bead pickup"), apex placement, and building the nail structure.
 - **Finish:** Filing and shaping (e.g., coffin, almond), buffing to a smooth finish, and applying top coat.

D. Station 4: Advanced skin care

- **OBJECTIVE:** To perform a complete "European Facial" with a focus on skin analysis.
- **TIME LIMIT:** 1 hour.
- **KEY SKILLS TO DEMONSTRATE:**
 - **Hygiene:** Clean trolley, fresh linens, gloves.
 - **Consultation & Analysis:** Using a mock "client card" and a magnifying lamp to identify the client's skin type (e.g., oily, dry, combination).
 - **Procedure:** Following the 10-step process: Cleanse (x2), Analyze, Exfoliate, Steam, Extract (mock), Massage (effleurage, petrissage), Mask (correct for skin type), Tone, Moisturize, SPF.
 - **Client Care:** Confident, gentle touch and professionalism.

Evaluation questions

1. What is the primary risk of "overlapping" a relaxer retouch?
2. Why must you avoid products with SPF when doing makeup for flash photography?
3. What is the "apex" of a nail extension, and why is it important for structure?
4. Name the two primary massage movements used in a facial and describe them.
5. What is the final, most critical *chemical* step in a relaxer service?

Assignment questions

1. Draw a diagram of a head sectioned into 4 quadrants for a relaxer application. Label the order in which you would apply the chemical (1, 2, 3, 4).
2. Create a "Face Chart" for a "Traditional Bridal" makeup look, listing the products and colours you would use.
3. List 10 "contraindications" that would prevent you from performing a pedicure.
4. Write out the full 10 steps of a European facial, and list one product you would use for each step for a client with *oily* skin.
5. What is the difference between a "disinfectant" (like Barbicide) and a "sterilizer" (like an autoclave)? Which one is required for metal cuticle nippers?

WEEK 2: FIELD WORK

TOPIC: VISIT TO BEAUTY SALONS, SPAS, COSMETIC INDUSTRIES

Introduction

This week, we take our learning outside the classroom. The goal is to observe the "real world" of the beauty business, see professional standards in action, and understand the different ways a cosmetology career can look. You are representing the school, so professional conduct is mandatory.

A. Objectives of the field trip

1. **Observe business operations:** To see how a professional salon or spa is managed daily.
2. **Inspect hygiene and safety:** To observe real-world use of disinfection, sterilization (autoclaves), and client safety protocols.
3. **Analyze business models:** To compare a high-end spa (high price, low volume) with a busy salon (lower price, high volume).
4. **Network:** To ask professional questions and make connections in the industry.
5. **Observe technology:** To see advanced equipment (e.g., microdermabrasion machines, LED therapy, hydraulic chairs) in use.

B. What to observe

You will be given a "Field Trip Notebook" to fill out.

- **AT A SALON/SPA:**
 - **First Impression:** Is it clean? Well-lit? What is the "brand" or "feeling"?
 - **Service Menu:** What services do they offer? What are their prices?
 - **Hygiene:** Where is their hygiene station? Can you see Barbicide jars? Do they have an autoclave?
 - **Staff & Client Care:** How do the staff greet clients? Are they professional?
 - **Marketing:** How do they get clients? (e.g., Instagram, walk-ins).
- **AT A COSMETIC INDUSTRY (if possible):**

- **Scale:** Observe the difference between classroom production and mass production.
- **Quality Control (QC):** Look for the lab and the steps they take to ensure every product is the same.
- **Equipment:** Large mixing vats, automated filling/labeling machines.
- **Regulation:** Ask about their NAFDAC and SON certification process.

C. Post-visit report (briefing for Week 4)

After the visit, you will be required to write a full report. Start taking notes *during* the visit. The report will be a major part of your final grade.

Evaluation questions

1. What is the main purpose of our field trip?
2. What is a "business model" in the context of a salon?
3. What is "Quality Control" (QC) at a cosmetic factory?
4. List 3 things you should observe on a salon's "Service Menu."
5. What is the name of the machine used for 100% sterilization of metal tools?

Assignment questions

1. **PRACTICAL:** Write a 1-page summary of *one* of the businesses we visited. What was its name, what services did it offer, and what was your professional impression of it?
2. What are 5 "smart" questions you could ask a Salon Manager during our visit?
3. Compare and contrast the *atmosphere* and *pricing* of a "day spa" versus a "high-street salon."
4. Based on our visit, what was one piece of advanced equipment you saw that we do not have in the classroom? Research its function.
5. If you were to open your own salon, which of the businesses we visited would be your biggest competitor? Why?

WEEK 3: INDEPENDENT PROJECT WORK

TOPIC: STUDENTS RUN SUPERVISED BEAUTY MINI-BUSINESS

Introduction

This is your final, capstone project. You will apply all your skills from SS1, SS2, and SS3. For one week, you (or your group) will run a real, supervised "mini-business" on the school premises. The goal is to provide real services to real clients (students, teachers) and **make a real profit**.

A. Phase 1: Planning (the "business plan")

1. **Service menu:** You must create a simple, *fast* service menu. You cannot offer 3-hour services.
 - *Good examples:* "Express Manicure (File & Polish)," "Eyebrow Shaping (Tweeze/Blade)," "Hand Massage," "10-min Natural Makeup Touch-up."
2. **Pricing:** Your prices must be realistic. You must calculate your **Cost of Materials (COM)** for each service.
 - *Example: Express Manicure*
 - COM (cotton, polish remover, base coat, top coat) = ₦80
 - Price = ₦300
 - **Profit = ₦220**
3. **Branding:** Give your mini-business a name (e.g., "The SS3 Beauty Bar," "JSS-to-Impress").
4. **Marketing:** How will you get clients?
 - Create a simple, eye-catching poster (A4 size).
 - Get permission to announce in the assembly.
 - Use word-of-mouth.

B. Phase 2: The setup (hygiene and professionalism)

- **Your "Salon":** You will be given a space (e.g., a corner of a hall).
- **Hygiene Station:** This is **mandatory** and will be graded. You must have:

- A hand sanitizer or hand-wash station.
- A jar of disinfectant (Barbicide) for your tools.
- Clean towels/linens.
- A bin for waste.
- **Professionalism:** You must wear your uniform, be polite, and practice good client care.

C. Phase 3: The logbook (tracking your success)

- You *must* keep a financial logbook. This is the most important part of your report.
- **Logbook Template:** | Date | Client Name | Service Provided | Revenue (₦) | Cost of Materials (₦) | Profit (₦) | | :--- | :--- | :--- | :--- | :--- | :--- | | Oct 20 | Jane (JSS2) | Eyebrow Shaping | 200 | 20 (spirit, blade) | 180 | | Oct 20 | Mrs. Adio | Express Manicure | 300 | 80 (cotton, polish) | 220 | | | **TOTAL** | **500** | **100** | **400** |

Evaluation questions

1. What is "Cost of Materials" (COM)?
2. What is the difference between "Revenue" and "Profit"?
3. Why is a "Hygiene Station" mandatory for your project?
4. Why is it a good idea to offer *fast* services (like "Express Manicure") instead of long ones?
5. List three ways you can market your mini-business within the school.

Assignment questions

1. **PRACTICAL:** Create your 1-page "Service Menu" with a brand name, at least 4 services, and your prices.
2. **PRACTICAL:** Create the poster you will use to advertise your business.
3. **PRACTICAL:** Set up your "Financial Logbook" (draw the table in a notebook), ready for your first client.
4. Calculate the "Cost of Materials (COM)" for an "Eyebrow Shaping" service. List the items and their approximate cost.
5. What will be your biggest *challenge* in this project, and how do you plan to handle it?

WEEK 4: REPORT WRITING

TOPIC: DOCUMENTING PROJECT EXPERIENCES

Introduction

The project is not finished until the paperwork is done. A professional report documents your activities, proves your financial results, and critically analyzes your experience. This report will be a major part of your final SS3 grade.

A. Structure of the final project report

Your report must be neat, well-written, and contain the following sections:

1. **COVER PAGE:** Your Project Name, Your Name, Class, Date.
2. **INTRODUCTION (1 paragraph):**
 - What was your business? What was your goal?
3. **BUSINESS PLAN (1-2 pages):**
 - Your "Service Menu" (the one you created in Week 3).
 - Your "Marketing Poster" (the one you created).
 - A description of your "Hygiene Station."
4. **FINANCIAL REPORT (The most important part):**
 - A clean, final copy of your "Financial Logbook."
 - A final summary:
 - **Total Revenue:** ₦_____
 - **Total Costs:** ₦_____
 - **Final Profit/Loss:** ₦_____
5. **ANALYSIS AND CHALLENGES (1-2 pages):**
 - **What Worked?** Which service was your *most popular*? Which was your *most profitable*?
 - **What Went Wrong?** Be honest. (e.g., "We ran out of polish," "Clients didn't come on Monday," "Our prices were too low").
 - **Client Feedback:** What did your clients say?

6. CONCLUSION (1 paragraph):

- What is the *most important lesson* you learned from this project?
- If you did it again, what *one thing* would you change?

B. Analyzing your business

- **Popularity vs. Profitability:** You may find that "Eyebrow Shaping" was your most popular service (you did 20 of them), but "Express Manicure" was your most profitable (it had a higher profit margin). This is a key business lesson.
- **Honesty:** You will be graded on your *honest analysis*, not just on making a large profit. A project that "failed" but has an excellent report on *why* it failed can get a top grade.

Evaluation questions

1. What are the 6 main sections of the final project report?
2. Which section is the most important for your grade?
3. What is the difference between your "most popular" service and your "most profitable" service?
4. Why is it important to be honest about your "Challenges" and "What Went Wrong"?
5. Where would you include your "Service Menu" in the report?

Assignment questions

1. **PRACTICAL:** Write your complete, final project report. This is the main assignment for the week.
2. Calculate your "Profit Margin" as a percentage for your *most popular* service. (Formula: $(\text{Profit} / \text{Price}) * 100$).
3. Write a one-paragraph "Conclusion" for your report, focusing on the most important lesson you learned.
4. Gather two "client testimonials" (reviews) from students or teachers you served. Include them in your "Analysis" section.
5. Write a "Thank You" note to the school for the opportunity, which can be included as an appendix to your report.

WEEK 5: MIDTERM TEST

TOPIC: MOCK PRACTICAL AND PROJECT PRESENTATION

Content

This week's test will be a combination of practical skills and a presentation of your project report.

- **Part 1: Project presentation (50%):** You will "present" your project report (from Week 4) to the teacher. You must be able to explain your financials, your challenges, and what you learned, just like pitching to an investor.
- **Part 2: Mock practical (50%):** You will be given a timed "spot test" from the WAEC/NECO practical syllabus (e.g., "Identify these 10 tools," "Perform a 10-minute hand massage," "Set up a hygienic station for a facial").

Evaluation questions

1. What are the two parts of your midterm test?
2. What is the most important financial number to explain during your presentation?
3. What items would you expect in a "spot test" for identifying tools?
4. How would you set up a "hygienic station" in 2 minutes?
5. What is the goal of a "project presentation"?

Assignment questions

1. Prepare a 5-minute verbal "pitch" (presentation) of your project.
2. Review all tools and equipment from the SS1 and SS2 syllabus.
3. Practice the 10 steps of a basic manicure (dry).
4. Practice the main facial massage movements (effleurage, petrissage) on your own arm.
5. Review the "Blood-Spill Protocol" step-by-step.

WEEK 6: MOCK EXAMINATION

TOPIC: FULL WAEC/NECO SIMULATION

Content

This week is a full-scale, timed simulation of the external SSCE examination. This will show you exactly what to expect and highlight your remaining weak spots.

- **PAPER 1: OBJECTIVES (1 HOUR)**
 - 50 multiple-choice questions covering the entire 3-year syllabus.
- **PAPER 2: THEORY (2 HOURS)**
 - Essay-style questions. You must answer 4-5 questions, showing your in-depth knowledge. (e.g., "Explain the 10 steps of a facial," "Describe the blood-spill protocol").
- **PAPER 3: PRACTICAL (1.5 HOURS)**
 - Specimen identification (tools, products, parasites, disorders) and practical questions.
- **POST-MOCK REVIEW:** We will grade the exam and conduct a "post-mortem" to review the most commonly missed questions. This is the most important part of the mock.

Evaluation questions

1. What are the three papers in the SSCE Cosmetology exam?
2. What is the purpose of the "post-mortem" review?
3. What type of questions are in Paper 2?
4. What is a "specimen" in the practical exam?
5. How much time do you have for the 50-question objective paper?

Assignment questions

1. Based on your mock results, what is your *weakest* topic? (e.g., "Hair Chemistry," "Anatomy," "Spa Services").

2. Write down 10 "keywords" from the objective test that you did not know. Look up their definitions.
3. Choose your *worst* question from the Theory paper and re-write the answer correctly.
4. Create flashcards for all the "specimens" you failed to identify.
5. How will you manage your time differently in the real exam?



WEEK 7: MIDTERM BREAK

- This break is for final, independent revision. Use your Mock Exam results to create a personal study plan.



WEEK 8: FINAL REVISION

TOPIC: PAST QUESTIONS PRACTICE

Content

This is the final week of instruction. We will not learn new material. We will only drill WAEC/NECO past questions, focusing on "keywords" and "exam technique."

A. "Must-Know" topics (The "Hot List")

- **HYGIENE:** Sanitation vs. Disinfection vs. Sterilization.
- **ANATOMY:** Labeling diagrams of Skin, Hair, and Nails.
- **CHEMISTRY:** The pH scale. Relaxer (Alkaline) vs. Perm (Acid).
- **DISORDERS:** Contraindications. Know how to identify (pictures) and *what to do* for: Ringworm (Fungus), Eczema, Psoriasis, Scabies, Warts.
- **PROCEDURES:** The 10-step facial. The 5-step pedicure. The blood-spill protocol.

B. "Keyword" drill

This is a rapid-fire drill.

- *Teacher:* "Matrix?" -> *Student:* "The living part of the nail that produces the nail plate."
- *Teacher:* "Cortex?" -> *Student:* "The middle layer of the hair, contains colour and disulfide bonds."
- *Teacher:* "Effleurage?" -> *Student:* "Gentle, stroking massage movement."
- *Teacher:* "Petrissage?" -> *Student:* "Kneading massage movement."
- *Teacher:* "NAFDAC?" -> *Student:* "Regulates safety and registration of cosmetic products in Nigeria."
- *Teacher:* "Contraindication?" -> *Student:* "A condition that means you cannot perform the service."

C. Final exam advice

- Read the questions twice.
- "List" means list. "Explain" means write full sentences.
- Do not leave any objective questions blank.
- For the practical, a clean, professional appearance and a sanitized kit are half the battle.

Evaluation questions

1. What is the difference between a "disinfectant" and an "antiseptic"?
2. What is the "cortex" of the hair?
3. What is "effleurage"?
4. Is a relaxer acidic or alkaline?
5. What is a "contraindication"?

Assignment questions

1. Complete the 2021 WAEC Cosmetology Theory paper (all questions) at home.
2. Complete the 2022 WAEC Cosmetology Objective paper (all questions) at home.
3. Draw and label the 3 layers of the skin.
4. Draw and label the 6 main parts of the nail.
5. Write out the full, step-by-step "Blood-Spill Protocol."

WEEK 9-13: WAEC/NECO EXAMINATIONS

TOPIC: EXTERNAL EXAMINATIONS

Content

This is it. All your hard work over the last three years comes down to this.

- Arrive at the exam hall early.
- Come prepared (pencils, pens, and for the practical, your full, sanitized kit).
- Read every question carefully.
- Stay calm and confident. You have been prepared for this.

